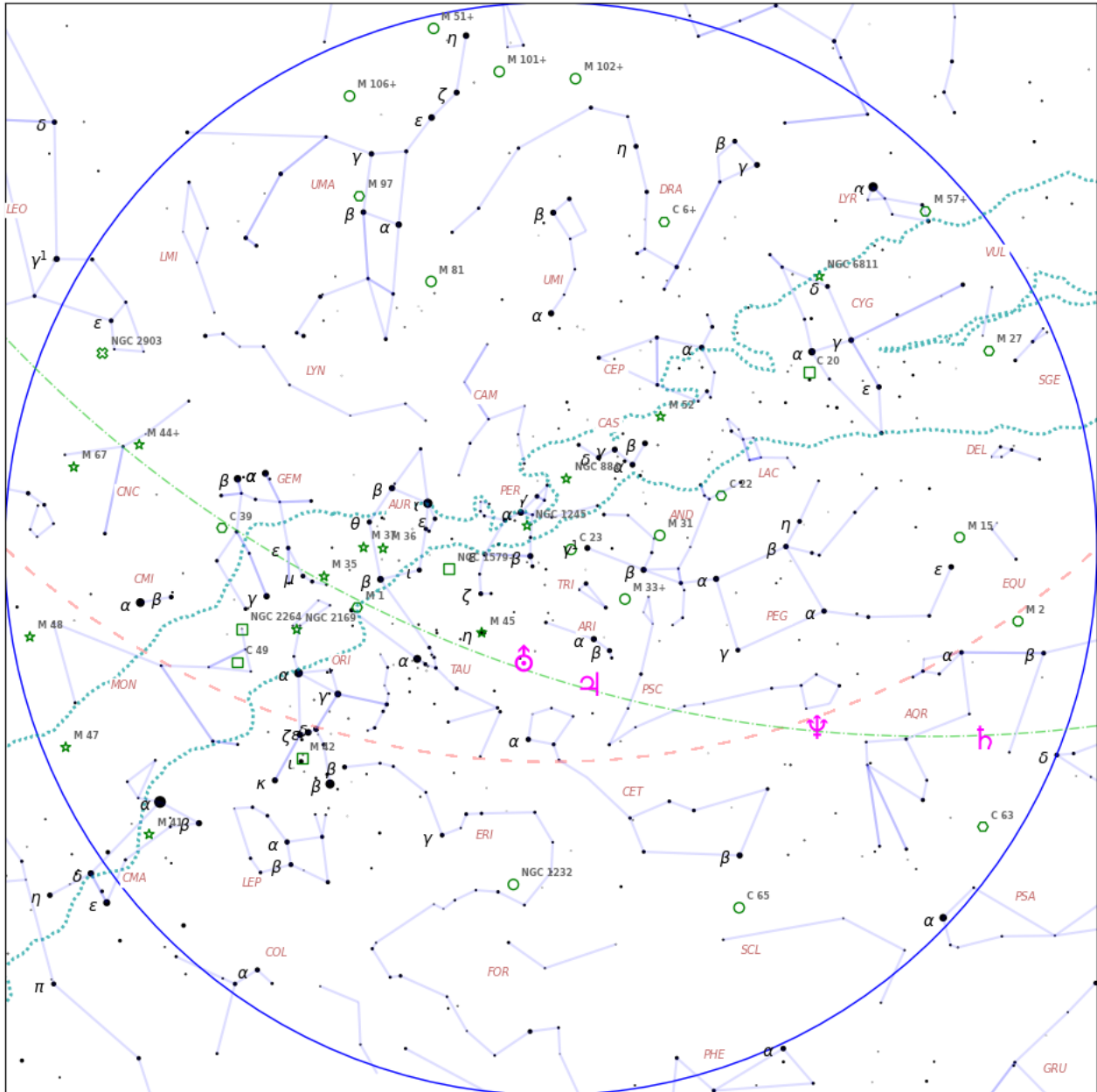


Skymap: Friday Dec 15, 2023 9:00 PM -0500



74 Church St. North Adams MA

December 2023 Skymap

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Lady*
 AQR - Aquarius - *the Water Bearer*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 AUR - Auriga - *the Charioteer*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 CET - Cetus - *the Whale*
 CMA - Canis Major - *the Big Dog*
 CMI - Canis Minor - *the Little Dog*
 CNC - Cancer - *the Crab*
 COL - Columba - *the Dove*
 CYG - Cygnus - *the Swan*
 DEL - Delphinus - *the Dolphin*
 EQU - Equuleus - *the Little Horse*
 ERI - Eridanus - *the River*
 FOR - Fornax - *the Chemical Furnace*
 GEM - Gemini - *the Twins*
 LAC - Lacerta - *the Lizard*
 LEO - Leo - *the Lion*
 LEP - Lepus - *the Hare*
 LMI - Leo Minor - *the Little Lion*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 LYR - Lyra - *the Harp*
 MON - Monoceros - *the Unicorn*
 ORI - Orion - *the Hunter*
 PEG - Pegasus - *the Winged Horse*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PHE - Phoenix - *the Phoenix*
 PSC - Pisces - *the Fish*
 SCL - Sculptor - *the Sculptor's Workshop*
 SGE - Sagitta - *the Arrow*
 TAU - Taurus - *the Bull*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*

Planets

♃ - Jupiter, ♄ - Saturn,
♅ - Uranus, ♆ - Neptune

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right.

Because of the Earth’s motion around the Sun, the time of this chart changes slowly over time, becoming roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Date	Time
Dec 1	10 PM
Dec 8	9:30 PM
Dec 15	9 PM
Dec 22	8:30 PM
Dec 29	8 PM

For binoculars: the Perseus Double Cluster is almost overhead; several other bright clusters can be found following the Milky Way NE to Cassiopeia or SW into Auriga, Gemini, and Monoceros. The Pleiades shine just East of Jupiter. The Orion Nebula is also coming into view (though it will be higher in January and February).

Telescopes can check out galaxies in possibly unfamiliar locations: NGC 1232 (the Eye of God Galaxy) and NGC 1300 in Eridanus are low-altitude objects (about where the nebulae in Sagittarius are in the summer), but large and comparatively bright (slightly better than M 33). In the North, Caldwell 5 and 7 are two dim galaxies in Camelopardalis that might be challenging but well worth the effort.

There are nebular challenges in Perseus - NGC 1579 (the Northern Trifid), and NGC 1624 (the Tribble Nebula). Uranus is near opposition: you can resolve enough of a dish with a 6” scope to tell it’s not a star with an almost eerie green color. And too many star clusters to mention in CAS/PER/AUR.